

Introduction to Artificial Intelligence

Course Notes - Lecture 1 | Professor Jane Doe

Artificial Intelligence (AI) refers to the simulation of human intelligence in machines that are programmed to think like humans and mimic their actions. The term may also be applied to any machine that exhibits traits associated with a human mind such as learning and problem-solving. This lecture covers the basic history and definitions of AI, from Alan Turing's early computing machinery to modern deep neural networks.

1. Core Philosophy

The core philosophy of AI rests on understanding cognitive models and reproducing computational agents that can perceive their environment, reason about actions, and maximize their chance of successfully achieving their goals. We distinguish between weak AI (narrowly focused on specific tasks) and strong AI (general cognitive abilities comparable to human intelligence).